

# Yes 4 Youth

## Training Program for Theatre Animators



## Yes4Youth Training Program for Theatre Animators

“Yes 4 Youth” is a capacity building training program targeting teachers, social workers and animators in cultural centres who work with children. The aim of the program is to help young professionals in the entire Hebron Governorate to develop their skills, gain inspiring and practical experiences, and create useful contacts. In a period of six months, the “Yes 4 Youth” program trains 15 youths in the Hebron District in basic techniques from the fields of theatre, drama, storytelling, theatre games and more. The program is both designed and implemented by Yes Theatre with the support of the German NGO WFD, World Peace Service (*“Weltfriedensdienst”*).



## The Yes 4 Youth Training Program

### Yes4Youth Training program

Yes4Youth targets young adults who are already working with children. The basic training period is to take place from February to August on a basis of two afternoons a week, four hours in each. During the first four months, the trainees will take classes in different subjects such as acting basics, storytelling, drama games, movement on stage..etc. In the last two months, external trainers from Palestine and abroad will offer new classes on “Theatre of the Oppressed”, “Puppet-theatre and Puppet Making”, “First Aid and Child Safety”, and more. At the end of the program trainees will be given certificates from both Yes Theatre and WFD. In addition, YT will give an opportunity

for five trainees to get immediate practical experience as trainers' assistants during the rehearsals and performances of YT's "Kids4Kids" plays.

After the basic training period, "Yes 4 Youth" will regularly offer advanced workshops with guest trainers, who will provide the fresh graduates with the chance to extend their theatre-based skills. In addition, Yes Theatre will involve the graduates in its future workshops and activities, it will inform them about work opportunities, and it will even help them in creating contacts with organizations working in the cultural sector.

## 2010 – A Successful Start

2010 was the first year of the Yes Theatre's "Yes 4 Youth" project. In the pilot program, 17 young adults from the entire Hebron District were trained for four months in the "basic acting techniques", "storytelling", "music and sound", "theatre games", "moving on stage", "breathing and rhythm", "planning and organization", "child safety" and "first aid". Afterwards, the graduates had the chance to improve their skills in advanced workshops on "forum theatre", "theatre of the oppressed", "puppet theatre", and "street theatre". Two graduates worked for three months as assistant directors in the Yes Theatre's "Kids4Kids" program. Under the supervision of our artistic staff, they implemented a month-long drama workshop, and facilitated all performances.

At the beginning of 2011, nine graduates implemented drama workshops in different schools and cultural centres in the entire Hebron District, and three of "Yes 4 Youth" graduates acted in the Yes Theatre's "Play 4 Kids" of 2011 ( A play on school drop-outs).







## Why do we work in Hebron ?

Israel's ongoing military occupation and colonization of Hebron has particularly rendered the situation in the city tense and explosive . When the illegal colony Kiryat Arba was created in the eastern part of Hebron City in 1967, more right-wing settlers illegally moved to live in the newly-created colony. Since then, they have been engaged in an open policy of judaizing the Old City of Hebron. Today, the illegal Israeli colonies and outposts built in the city house an increasing number of fanatic settlers. Around 420 radical Israeli settlers, who have taken over the Palestinian buildings, shops, and houses, live in the Old City of Hebron that is denoted as H2. Under the "protection" of around 1500 Israeli soldiers, these settlers regularly harass and abuse the local population of Hebron and have, thus far, led to the displacement of half of its residents. In 1994, immediately following the Abraham Mosque massacre, 96% of the local population fled the Old City according to the Hebron Rehabilitation Committee (HRC). Only few families have dared to return there. In addition, 1662 small businesses were either welded shut by the Israeli army or were closed down by settlers according to HRC. Streets in H2 are now off-limits to Palestinian vehicular traffic. According to the United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, there were 122 permanent closures just in H2 in 2010.

Due to the continuous presence of the occupying forces and colonizers, most families in Hebron have experienced military curfews. They have had family members – including children – detained, usually without any charges. In addition, they have had family and friends injured or killed, or have had their property illegally expropriated.

In comparison with West Bank cities like Ramallah or Jerusalem, there are very few organizations that offer extra-curricular activities or training opportunities to children and youth in Hebron.

Therefore, Yes Theatre has been devotedly working since its establishment in 2008 on empowering an ever increasing number of children through theatre and drama activities. Furthermore, it has been also working on increasing the number of theatre-animators and drama-teachers in the region. The Yes 4 Youth Training Program for Theatre Animators is the most recent in a series of programs aiming at promoting the use of drama-based techniques in child education.

## Yes Theatre

Yes Theatre was established in 2008 by Ihab Zahda, Mohammad titi, and Raed Shyoukhi to continue the work of 13 years long in the field of Drama and Theatre. It is a community theatre that focuses mainly on empowering children and youth through using the tools of theatre and drama.

The core programs of Yes Theatre include “Play4Kids”, “Kids 4 Kids” and “Yes4Youth” projects. In “Play4Kids” the artistic staff designs a play specifically catered to school children from Hebron and performs it to school classes from the entire city. “Kids4Kids” project, produces theatre plays that are rehearsed with school children during the summer holidays and then performed to peers, parents and teachers. The third project is “Yes4Youth Training Program for theatre animators as previously explained. In addition to these projects, YT implements drama workshops at schools and cultural centres.

In addition, Yes Theatre hosts local and international artists for theatre performances and workshops, organizes and implements theatre workshops for school teachers in cooperation with the Ministry of Education, UNRWA, and local partners. Yes Theatre opens its doors to over 13,000 school children per year and offers them the chance to see a theatre performance and participate in after-show discussions and theatre games.



## The Partnership with WFD

World Peace Service (Weltfriedensdienst WFD) is a German NGO working on development cooperation since 1959. In the framework of its Civil Peace Service, WFD funds projects with local partner organizations in Africa, Latin America, and Palestine, and provides long-term on-location consultancy. Through its international partner projects, WFD engages in the fields of civil conflict management, human rights, women's rights, economic development, education and training, and agricultural activities aiming at preserving natural resources.

WFD has had a long-standing relationship of solidarity with Palestine since 1968 when the organization started to support a women's embroidery collective in Kfar Na'me near the West Bank village of Bil'in. While this partnership still continues to date, WFD now focuses on strengthening Palestinian civil society through supporting Palestinian NGOs that provide arts-based and psychosocial intervention. WFD has been supporting the Yes Theatre in its Yes 4 Youth project since July 2009. WFD has also been supporting al-Mada – a music therapy centre in Ramallah – since early 2009, and the family therapy centre "Guidance and Training Centre for the Family and Child" in Bethlehem since 2010.

